SHELL EXPANSION

A dollar sign in a hash returned 401 in production

> My CRM login worked locally. In July a shell variable mangled the password hash on its way to Vercel.

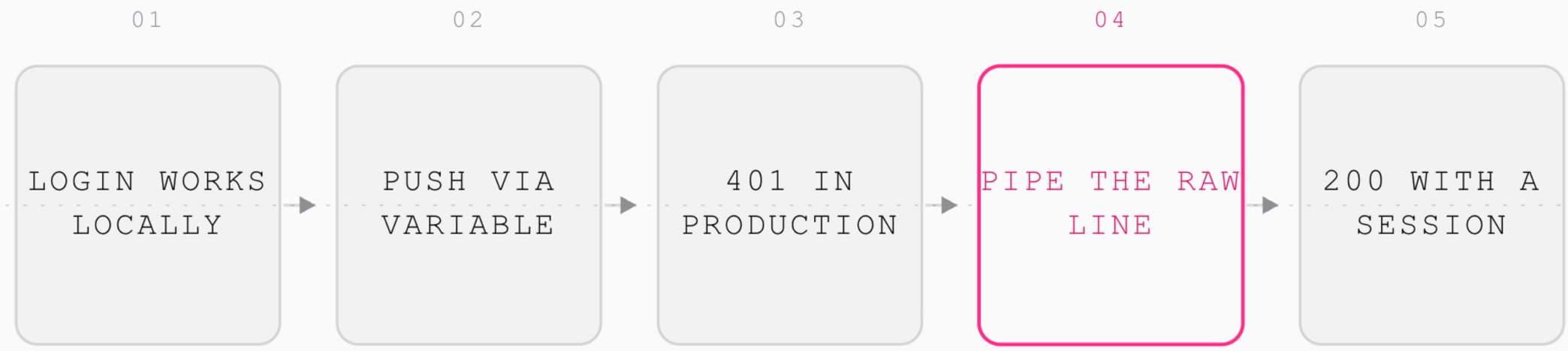
READ ON

THE JULY BUG

Works locally, 401 in production, 200 after one fix

In July I pushed the bcrypt hash to Vercel through a sourced shell variable. Re-adding it by piping the raw line from the .env file fixed it.

EXHIBIT 02 VERYDIAN



THE MECHANISM

The shell is a transformation you didn't ask for

A dollar sign is syntax to the shell. Sending the value through a shell variable meant the shell got a say. Piping the raw line gave it none.

EXHIBIT 03 VERYDIAN

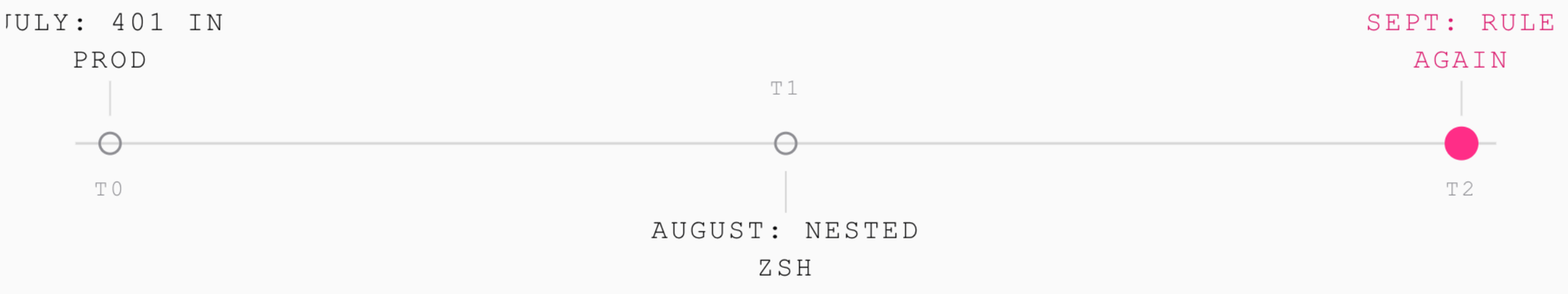
SHELL VARIABLE		PIPED RAW LINE
— SHELL EXPANDS $	VS	• NO EXPANSION
— HASH MANGLED		• HASH INTACT

THE PATTERN

Same failure class, two projects

In July, the CRM. In August, a different project with nested zsh. The handoff repeated the rule in September.

EXHIBIT 04 VERYDIAN



THE RULES

The standing rules, as written in the handoffs

Never pass a hash through shell expansion; pipe the raw line. For multi-line commands, write a .sh file, source ~/.zshrc, export explicitly inside it, never zsh -lc.

EXHIBIT 05 VERYDIAN

01
PIPE THE RAW LINE

02
WRITE A .SH FILE

03
EXPORT INSIDE FILE

04
NO ZSH -LC



Put the rule where the next session reads it

Mine live in the handoffs now.

WRITE IT DOWN